

an opportunity that they see. If you are a participant in the industry at a company, that can't be the government's responsibility to handhold you for your career progression. That is something that individual professionals find a way to finance and grow. Of course, there are many schemes within the broader Government of India that allow for loans and educational financing for underprivileged sections of our society... there is basic skilling, which is being given for free. Almost 30 million Indians have been skilled in the last five years. And then, in the market, there are sectoral platforms that are aimed at upskilling and/or multiple skilling; where an engineer or graduate can become a software engineer or a coder; or a coder who's coding in a particular language can then learn coding in multiple languages—that is not an area which the government believes should be free.



According to industry reports, 95 per cent of workers surveyed in India acknowledged requiring more digital skills. Despite this, only 45 per cent of employers in India have a training plan in place. What can India do to skill its workforce?

The principal stakeholder in the success of an organisation is the enterprise itself. In today's world, an

enterprise is as successful as its employees are, as its workforce is. This is the basic mathematics of the 'New World'. If an enterprise chooses to not have a talented workforce, that enterprise will fail. This is the new normal... If it wants to remain competitive, continue to grow [and] continue to go after all these new opportunities in this rapidly changing technology world or indeed any other segment of the economy today, it has to be the one that invests resources in making sure its talent is upskilled, reskilled, multiple skilled, currently skilled,

them, I tell them that the next two years represent an unprecedented type of opportunity for Indian tech. And if you as a big company today go to sleep on the issue of talent, some other young small start-up company will grow, expand, invest in talent and eat your lunch and breakfast in the next two years. So [your] survival today depends on how talented your workforce is. Success depends on that and how talented your workforce is, it depends a lot on continuous skilling, reskilling, upskilling and multiple skilling.

There are a series of areas that are going to be relevant and really big opportunities, both economically and strategically for our industry, and the country. We are evangelising. Our ministry is really about creating awareness, energy and passion, and being an enabler with the tools in skilling, tools in terms of financing start-ups, or helping start-ups get bootstrapped. That is what our business is and our job is. We understand the value of India's Techade. It's like the Y2K moment for India's tech space. This trillion-dollar digital economy is there for us to take.

I THINK A LITTLE BIT OF SLACKNESS ON THE PART OF THE INDUSTRY IS ONE OF THE REASONS FOR WHAT WE ARE SEEING TODAY—WAGE INFLATION, SHORTAGE OF TALENT IN CERTAIN SEGMENTS... LIKE AI AND OTHER AREAS

contemporarily skilled. A talented workforce is the biggest determinant of the success and growth of an enterprise, and technology companies are big knowing this. Of course, there are Indian technology companies that have become so big that they think they can get a little lazy and sleepy on this. But every time I meet



How is the government looking at skilling in artificial intelligence, machine learning and blockchain?

The Prime Minister has said the next decade is India's 'Techade', and if that is so, we have to lead the charge on Web 3.0, ML, AI, supercomputing, and quantum computing.

But we have to take a lot of very significant steps as corporates and with a very supportive government. We will do whatever is necessary as a ministry to enable that both in terms of skilling and continuing to boost the start-up and innovation ecosystem in the country. **BT**

@nidhisingal